

were not altogether successful: he enrolled at the Paris Conservatoire in 1879, but was soon dismissed for lacking the necessary talent and dedication. Rejected but not disheartened, he rejoined the Conservatoire in 1885, but met with the same criticism of his abilities, and decided to leave the following year to join the army.



MONTMARTRE

The district of Montmartre, crowned by the basilica of the Sacré-Cœur, became a focus of artistic activity in the Belle Epoque, largely because of its low rents.